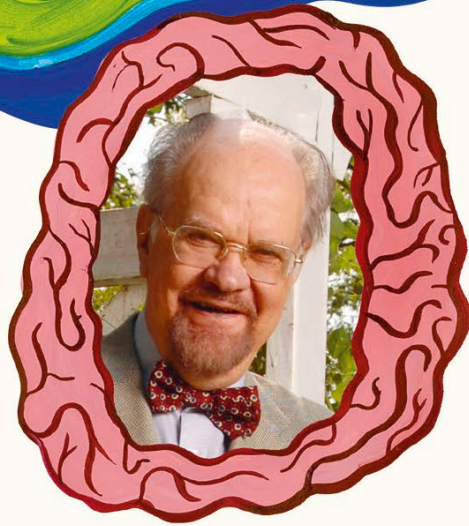




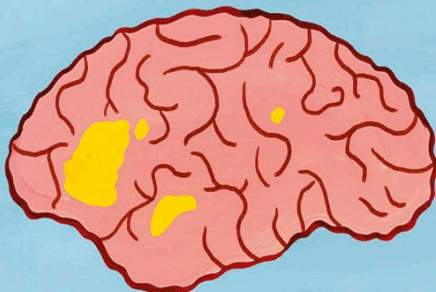
# ENDEL TULVING

Canadian–Estonian  
psychologist and  
neuroscientist  
1927–present

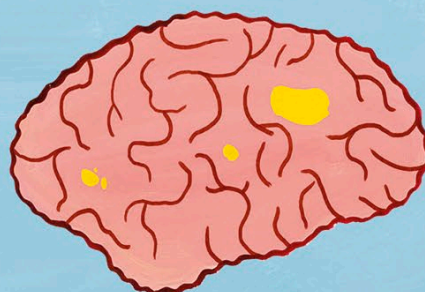
**C**an you remember what you got for your last birthday? How about your first? Why is it easy to remember the meaning of every word in this sentence, but hard to recall what you ate for lunch last Tuesday? Memory is one of the most mysterious things in science.

Endel Tulving is a scientist who set out to understand it. He grew up in Europe, then moved to Canada in 1949, where he studied psychology—the science of the human mind and behavior. This was a new science at the time, and there were so many unanswered questions.

*Endel used brain scans to show that different parts of the brain “light up” with activity when we store memories and when we retrieve them.*



*Storing a memory*



*Accessing a memory*

*Episodic memory*



## Types of memory

Endel came up with a theory to explain how our brains organize long-term memories. Episodic memory lets us play back things we have seen or done ourselves, such as our last birthday party. Semantic memory stores the things we have learned and now know—such as what a dog is! Endel later added a third type of memory to his theory: procedural memory. This type stores information about how to do things, such as riding a bike.